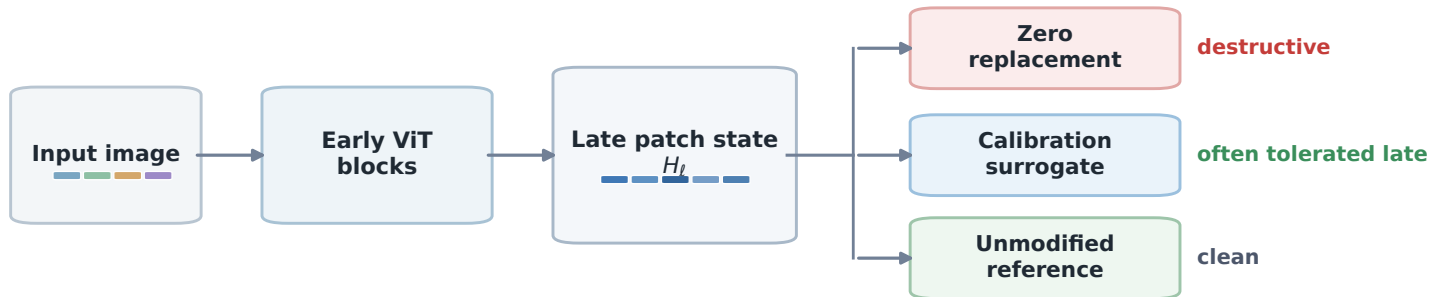


(a) Activation substitution isolates what late patch states must preserve



Upstream image processing is unchanged; [CLS], token slots, sequence length, model weights, and downstream blocks remain fixed.

(b) Geometry



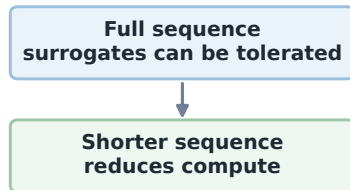
Feature-coordinate identity and orientation matter.

(c) Diversity



Complete replacement still requires token diversity.

(d) Boundary



but

matched pruning $\geq$ synthetic carrier